

BYU INFORMATION SYSTEMS

Junior Core Case Competition

IS Career Launchpad

A Group Case Study in IS Career Exploration and Interview Preparation

Case Logistics at a Glance

Prepare a working prototype + recorded video presentation + individual reflection

See grading rubric in Section 5 for full weighting

All deliverables due **Friday September 4th at 8:00 AM**

Section 1: Background & Context

Information Systems is one of the most versatile degrees in the business school. IS graduates work across industries — from Fortune 500 tech teams to healthcare startups — in roles ranging from software developer to business analyst to cybersecurity specialist. Yet many incoming IS students struggle to articulate what career paths are available to them, let alone how to prepare for the internships and entry-level jobs that lead to those paths.

This case puts you in the position of solving that problem — not just for yourself, but for the students who will come after you.

The Core Problem

IS students frequently report two related challenges:

1. They are unaware of the full range of IS career paths, often defaulting to a narrow view of what the degree leads to and not deciding on what they want to do until their last semester.
2. They are underprepared for the technical and behavioral components of internship and job interviews.

Both issues compound each other: students who do not know what careers exist cannot effectively prepare for them.

1.1 Why This Matters

The hiring cycle starts soon! The 2026 STEM fair is on Thursday, September 17, and the majority of IS students begin applying for internships and jobs this month. Students who understand the landscape of IS careers and who have practiced technical interview skills gain a measurable early advantage. This case challenges you to leverage the power of artificial intelligence tools to build something genuinely useful to assist you in your job search.

1.2 Your Role

You and your team have been engaged as a consulting group by the BYU IS Department. Your client has a clear mandate:

Client Mandate

Design and build a prototype tool that helps incoming IS students:

1. Discover and explore the range of IS career paths available to IS students and graduates, and
2. Prepare for technical and behavioral interviews for internships in those jobs.

The tool must be functional, not just conceptual. You will demonstrate it in a recorded video.

Section 2: The Challenge

Your team must design and build the IS Career Launchpad — a web app prototype with two core modules. Both modules must be functional and demonstrated during your recorded video presentation. You are free to use AI tools to build the prototype.

Part 1 — Career Path Discovery Module

Build an interactive tool that allows a student to explore the industry for IS graduates. What are the different industries they can enter, what are the job categories, what are the specific role titles? In essence, for each career path it covers, the tool must help a user understand all the following:

- What a role does on a day-to-day basis
- What technical skills and tools are typically required
- What an entry-level or internship candidate is expected to know
- Realistic salary ranges and growth trajectories
- What makes a strong candidate for that role

You must cover at least four career paths. However, you can explore and include any IS career tracks you discover. Some suggested tracks include:

- Software / Application Developer
- Business / Systems Analyst
- Data Analyst or Data Scientist
- Cybersecurity Analyst
- IT Project Manager
- UX Designer / Product Manager
- ERP / Systems Consultant (e.g., SAP, Salesforce)
- Cloud / Infrastructure Engineer

Be creative! The format of this module is up to your team. You might build a chatbot, an interactive web page, a decision-tree tool, a map, or something else entirely. Prioritize usefulness and clarity over visual polish. If including statistics, you should be able to explain where your data and information sources come from.

Part 2 — Interview Prep Module

For at least four of the careers covered in Part 1, build a functional mock interview tool. This tool should:

- Ask the user role-appropriate interview questions (both behavioral and technical)
- Let the user attempt a response
- Suggest strong versions of the answer where applicable

Technical questions should reflect what is actually asked in entry-level interviews for the role — not generic questions. Your team should research real interview formats for each career path you cover.

Guiding Question for Part 2

Ask yourselves: if a BYU IS junior used this tool for 30 minutes the night before an interview, would they be meaningfully better prepared?

If the answer is no, keep building.

Section 3: Requirements & Constraints

3.1 Technical Requirements

You are not constrained to use any specific tool. The output should be an HTML file that can be run on any browser.

You do not need to have a database or chat capability with an AI interface. If you do have time to incorporate those elements you can, but it is not required.

3.2 What You May Not Do

- Submit a slide deck as a substitute for a working tool
- Claim AI-generated content as your original research without attribution
- Use proprietary or paid data sources your team cannot legally access

3.3 Team Norms

This is a team project. All members are expected to contribute meaningfully. You will each complete a brief individual reflection at the end of the project (see Section 4) documenting your specific contributions.

A Note on Using AI to Build This Project

You are explicitly encouraged to use AI tools to help you write code, research career paths, and draft content. **This is not cheating; it is the point.**

What matters is that you understand what you built, can explain every component, and can speak to the decisions you made. If an evaluator asks how something works and you cannot answer, that is a problem.

Therefore, use AI to also teach you about what is going on as you build the project so you are familiar with all the components.

Use AI as a force multiplier. Do not use it as a replacement for your own thinking.

Section 4: Deliverables

Your team must submit and present the following by September 4th at 8:00 AM:

Deliverable	Description
Working Prototype	A functional tool with both modules. Must be accessible (whether deployed or an HTML file).
Video Presentation	Recorded video presentation, no longer than 5 minutes that demos your solution. Walk the evaluators through your tool on screen, showing it in action.
Individual Reflection	A brief written reflection submitted individually. Due at the same time as group deliverables.

Individual Reflection

Each team member will individually answer the following questions in a reflection document found [here](#).

Individual Reflection Questions

1. How did you feel about the process for designing this tool? What was the biggest technical or strategic decision your team made, and why?
2. What was your experience with AI? What was useful? What was frustrating?
3. If you had three more weeks, what would you build next — and how would you validate whether it was worth building?
4. Tell me about a moment during this project when your team disagreed. How did you resolve it, and what did you learn?

You will be evaluated not just on what you built, but on how you communicate about the experience of building it.

Team member evaluation

As part of the individual reflection, you will also be asked to rate your peers (and yourself) on their performance on the group project. These questions will be used at INTEX at the end of the semester, so we want you to start to see how a good group member could have diverse contributions. There will be a 1-5 scale with guidance on what each number means. In summary:

Team member evaluation questions

1. Contributing to the team's work

- a. *Did this person carry a fair share of the actual work and follow through on it?*
- 2. Interacting with teammates**
- a. *How did this person treat and work with the rest of the team?*
- 3. Keeping the team on track**
- a. *Did this person help the team stay organized, coordinated, and on schedule?*
- 4. Setting and holding a high standard**
- a. *Did this person care about the quality of the team's work and push for it?*
- 5. Bringing relevant knowledge and skills**
- a. *Did this person bring — or build — the skills the project needed?*

Section 5: Grading Rubric

Teams will be evaluated across four dimensions. The rubric below describes performance expectations at each level.

5.1 Grade Breakdown

Component	Weight
Career Discovery Module (functionality + depth)	30%
Interview Prep Module (functionality + feedback quality)	30%
Video Presentation & Communication	20%
Individual Reflection & Personal Accountability	20%

5.2 Rubric Detail

Criteria	Excellent (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Needs Work (D/F)
Career Discovery Module	Covers 4+ paths with rich, accurate detail. Tool is intuitive and genuinely helpful. Information is current and role-specific.	Covers 4 paths with adequate depth. Tool is functional. Most information is accurate.	Fewer than 4 paths or information is shallow/generic. Tool has usability issues.	Tool is non-functional or paths are inaccurate/missing.

Interview Prep Module	Questions are role-specific and realistic. Feedback is specific, actionable, and constructively critical. Covers behavioral and technical.	Questions are mostly role-appropriate. Feedback is helpful but sometimes generic. Covers at least one of each type.	Questions are generic or feedback lacks specificity. Partial coverage of question types.	Module is non-functional or feedback is unhelpful.
Video Presentation	All members communicate clearly and confidently. Demo runs smoothly.	Most members communicate well. Minor demo issues.	Uneven participation. Demo has issues.	Presentation is disorganized or demo fails.
Individual Reflection	Reflection is specific, honest, and demonstrates genuine learning. Contributions are clearly documented.	Reflection addresses the prompts adequately. Contributions are described.	Reflection is vague or minimal. Contributions are unclear.	Reflection is missing or does not address contributions.

Section 6: Guiding Questions for Your Team

These questions are not required deliverables — they are prompts to help your team think more deeply as you build. Strong teams will be able to answer most of these by the time of their presentation.

On Career Path Discovery

- How are you deciding which IS career paths to include? What sources are you using, and how are you validating accuracy?
- If a first-semester freshman with no technical background used your tool, what would they learn? What would still confuse them?
- How is your tool different from just Googling 'IS career paths'?

On Interview Preparation

- How did you research what questions are actually asked in entry-level interviews for each role? Did you use job postings, interview databases, or alumni networks?
- What makes good interview feedback? How did you determine good feedback?
- Have you tested your tool on someone outside your group? What did you learn?

On Your Process

- How did your team divide responsibilities? Was anyone blocked? How did you unblock them?
- What was the hardest technical problem you encountered? How did you solve it?
- What would you do differently if you started over?

On Using AI

- In what ways did AI make this project faster or better? In what ways did it fall short?
- Were there moments when the AI gave you bad or misleading output? How did you catch it?
- How does building an AI-powered tool change how you think about using AI in your future career?

Good luck — and build something you are proud of.

BYU Information Systems Department